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A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles

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Abstract

Aim: Childhood overweight and obesity is a serious public health concern in the UK. As part of a national initiative, parents and caregivers are provided information about their child's weight status and invited to attend healthy lifestyle programmes. Uptake to these programmes, however, is low. This study investigated the prospective acceptability of a healthy lifestyles

programme to help refine a commissioned programme. Subject and methods: Parents and caregivers of children aged 4–11 years were invited to respond to a survey and interviews. Responses were coded into domains of the theoretical framework of acceptability (TFA) using deductive thematic analysis. Results: Data from 60 survey respondents and six interviewees indicated that most participants would be open to attending a healthy lifestyles programme. Participants reported high levels of perceived effectiveness and self-efficacy. Barriers to attendance were identified in the domains of burden, opportunity costs, and ethicality, as well as a lack of information about the format, content, and target audience of the programme. Participants indicated that they would be more likely to enrol if they were aware the programme offered opportunities for social interaction and interactive, holistic learning. Conclusion: Although prospective acceptability of the healthy lifestyles programme is high, this did not translate to attendance at the programme. Using the TFA can inform both the intervention refinement process and how recruitment and marketing of the programme can be supported. Provision of more information about the aims, content, and delivery of the programme, and who the target audience is, would improve uptake rates.

Original language English

Pages (from-to) (In-Press)

Journal [Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)](#)

Volume (In-Press)

Early online date 29 May 2023

DOIs • <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z>

Publication status E-pub ahead of print - 29 May 2023

Bibliographical note

Publisher Copyright:

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Keywords

- Child obesity
- Child overweight
- Healthy lifestyles
- Prospective acceptability
- Weight management

ASJC Scopus subject areas

- Public Health, Environmental and Occupational Health

UN SDGs

This output contributes to the following UN [Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#)

- SDG 3 - Good Health and Well-being

Access to Document

- [10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z)

Other files and links

- [Link to publication in Scopus](#)

Embargoed Document

- Healthy Lifestyles Project_ Accepted_Clean

Accepted author manuscript, 69.4 KB

Embargo ends: 29/05/24

Fingerprint

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Bell, L., [Whelan, M.](#), Thomas, L., [Wright, H.](#), [Lycett, D.](#), Mckinnon, G., Southan, J., & Patel, R. (2023). [A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles. *Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)*, \(In-Press\), \(In-Press\).](#) Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z>
[A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles.](#) / Bell, Lauren; [Whelan, Maxine](#); Thomas, Lucie et al.
 In: [Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)](#), Vol. (In-Press), 29.05.2023, p. (In-Press).

Research output: Contribution to journal > Article > peer-review

Bell, L., [Whelan, M.](#), Thomas, L., [Wright, H.](#), [Lycett, D.](#), Mckinnon, G., Southan, J. & Patel, R 2023, '[A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles](#)', **[Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)](#)**, vol. (In-Press), pp. (In-Press). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z>

Bell L, [Whelan M](#), Thomas L, [Wright H](#), [Lycett D](#), Mckinnon G et al. [A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles. *Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)*. 2023 May 29;\(In-Press\):\(In-Press\).](#) Epub 2023 May 29. doi: 10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z

Bell, Lauren ; [Whelan, Maxine](#) ; Thomas, Lucie et al. / **[A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles.](#)** In: [Journal of Public Health \(Germany\)](#). 2023 ; Vol. (In-Press). pp. (In-Press).

@article{c2e08da8f6614141880173d96b5b193b,

title = "A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles",

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keywords = "Child obesity, Child overweight, Healthy lifestyles, Prospective acceptability, Weight management",

author = "Lauren Bell and Maxine Whelan and Lucie Thomas and Hayley Wright and Deborah Lycett and Gemma Mckinnon and Jo Southan and Riya Patel",

note = "Publisher Copyright: {\textcopyright} 2023, The Author(s), under exclusive licence to Springer-Verlag GmbH Germany, part of Springer Nature.",

year = "2023",

month = may,

day = "29",

doi = "10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z",

language = "English",

volume = "(In-Press)",

pages = "(In-Press)",

journal = "Journal of Public Health (Germany)",

issn = "2198-1833",

publisher = "Oxford University Press",

}

TY - JOUR

T1 - A mixed-methods evaluation of prospective acceptability for a family-targeted programme promoting healthy lifestyles

AU - Bell, Lauren

AU - Whelan, Maxine

AU - Thomas, Lucie

AU - Wright, Hayley

AU - Lycett, Deborah

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PY - 2023/5/29

Y1 - 2023/5/29

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KW - Child obesity

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KW - Healthy lifestyles

KW - Prospective acceptability

KW - Weight management

UR - <http://www.scopus.com/inward/record.url?scp=85160406107&partnerID=8YFLogxK>

U2 - 10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z

DO - 10.1007/s10389-023-01943-z

M3 - Article

AN - SCOPUS:85160406107

SN - 2198-1833

VL - (In-Press)

SP - (In-Press)

JO - Journal of Public Health (Germany)

JF - Journal of Public Health (Germany)

ER -



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